The world in brief

Catch up quickly on the global stories that matter

Photograph: AFP via Getty Images

Violence broke out across Mexico after security forces killed the leader of the **Jalisco New Generation Cartel**, the country's most notorious drug-trafficking gang. Nemesio Rubén Oseguera Cervantes (aka "El Mencho") was one of the traffickers most wanted by America's Drug Enforcement Administration. In response to the killing, gunmen blocked highways in several states and set cars alight.

The **European Parliament** looks set to delay the ratification of the trade agreement that the European Commission struck with **America** last year. Last week Donald Trump imposed new across-the-board levies of 15% after America's Supreme Court blocked most of his "emergency" tariffs. The EC said that Mr Trump's new levies were not "fair, balanced and mutually beneficial". Jamieson Greer, America's trade representative, called on trading partners to honour previously negotiated deals.

Secret Service agents shot dead **Austin Tucker Martin**, a 21-year-old who breached the perimeter of **Mar-a-Lago**, Mr Trump's residence in Florida. Authorities said officers told the intruder to drop what appeared to be a shotgun and a fuel canister, and that he

put down the canister but raised the gun to a “shooting position”. The president was not at Mar-a-Lago at the time.

American and **Iranian** officials will resume talks in Geneva on Thursday, according to mediators from Oman. The president hopes to convince Iran to give up its nuclear programme through diplomatic means, however speculation is mounting that Mr Trump is considering a large-scale attack if talks—or limited strikes—are unpersuasive. Abbas Araghchi, Iran’s foreign minister, said there was a good chance of “a diplomatic solution”.

Ukraine accused **Hungary** and **Slovakia** of “blackmail” after they threatened to cut off supplies of electricity. That threat was a response to Ukraine’s failure to resume transporting Russian oil to the two countries. Ukraine stopped shipments in January after Russian drones attacked its pipeline infrastructure. Meanwhile the government said a “terror attack” on Sunday in Lviv, a western Ukrainian city, killed a police officer.

Greenland declined Mr Trump’s offer to send an American hospital boat with medical supplies. The Arctic island’s prime minister, Jens-Frederik Nielsen, called Mr Trump’s claim that many Greenlanders are “not being taken care of” a “random outburst”. The defence minister of Denmark, of which Greenland is a semi-autonomous constituent, said that the territory did not need more health care.

Norway topped the final medal table in this year’s **Winter Olympics**, which finished on Sunday. America came second. The Scandinavian country, with a population of around 5.7m, has won the most or joint-most golds at every Winter Olympics since 2014. Johannes Hosflot Klaebo, a Norwegian cross-country skier, took home six golds, more than all but seven other countries won during the entire tournament.

Figure of the day: 1.1m. The approximate number of cars manufactured in Slovakia in 2025—more than anywhere else in the world per person. Read the full story.

Photograph: Reuters

Four years of fighting in Ukraine

As Russia's war of aggression against Ukraine enters its fifth year on Tuesday, hopes of a breakthrough in peace negotiations are low. The latest round of trilateral talks, which involve American go-betweens, ended abruptly in Geneva last week.

The most intractable disagreement is about territory. Russia is demanding that Ukraine cede the 20% of eastern Donetsk, which includes the well-defended "fortress belt", that it has failed to take by force. Such a concession would cross a Ukrainian red line. President Zelensky accused the Russians of having dragged out the talks and lecturing: "I don't need historical shit to end this war," he posted on X.

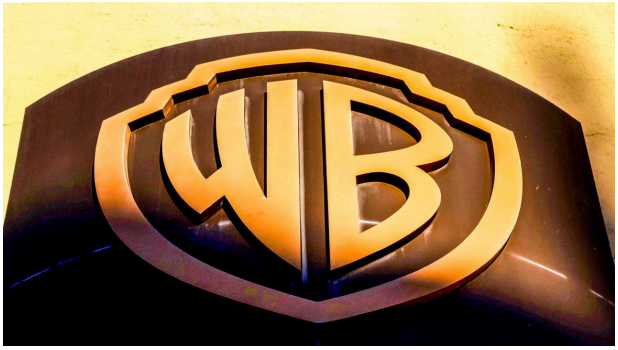
Donald Trump is pushing for a deal by June. But European intelligence agencies are reportedly pessimistic about the chances of an agreement this year—despite Russia's excruciatingly slow progress on the battlefield and stalling economy, Vladimir Putin, its president, does not yet seem to feel enough pressure to end his war.

Photograph: Hans Lucas/AFP via Getty Images

Europe mulls its response to Trump's tariffs

This week European parliamentarians will discuss the latest developments in Europe's trade tussle with Donald Trump. On Saturday America's president said that he would raise temporary tariffs on imports from all countries from 10% to 15%. That was his response to the Supreme Court's ruling the day before that many of his tariffs are illegal.

The European Union sees the substitute tariffs as a violation of its trade deal with the American government, which was initially agreed to in July 2025, pending ratification by the European Parliament. The EU put ratification on hold in January, after Mr Trump threatened additional levies on European countries that opposed his plan to acquire Greenland. The ratification vote, rescheduled for Tuesday, is likely to be delayed again. "As the United States' largest trading partner, the EU expects the US to honour its commitments," said the EU executive in an unusually strongly worded statement on Sunday. "A deal is a deal."



Photograph: Getty Images

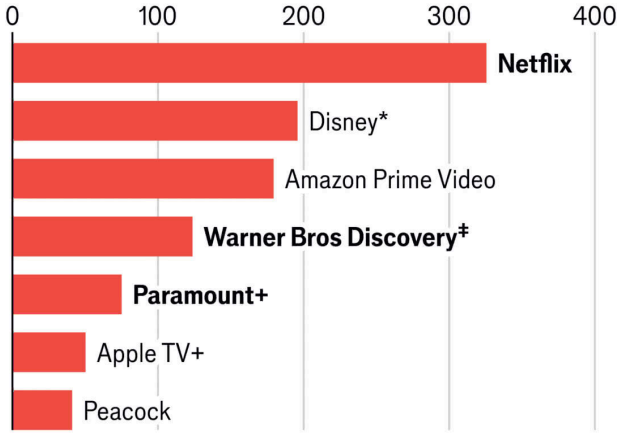
The final episode of the Warner Bros battle

Bring the popcorn. On Monday Paramount Skydance is expected to make its best—and final—offer to buy Warner Bros Discovery. In December the entertainment firm's board rejected Paramount's advances in favour of a bid from Netflix, a streaming giant. That has not put off Paramount. It suggested that it may raise its offer to more than $31 per share for the entirety of Warner, compared with Netflix's $27.8 bid for its streaming platform and studios.

Warner's board says it remains committed to Netflix. Its shareholders are divided over which suitor is more likely to secure regulatory approval for a deal. Paramount is the smaller buyer, and the friendship between its owners, the Ellison family, and President Donald Trump could help. (European and British regulators also need to give their nod.) Netflix says it would not dominate the television sector even after a merger. The saga will move into its next season on March 20th, when Warner's shareholders are due to vote.

No business like showbusiness

Global streaming subscriptions, m
Selected companies, Q3 2025



*Disney+, Disney+ Hotstar and Hulu
‡Discovery+ and HBO Max
Source: Ampere Analysis

Photograph: Getty Images

Duterte chooses a jail cell over a courtroom

On Monday the International Criminal Court in The Hague began a week of hearings to determine whether there is enough evidence to put Rodrigo Duterte, a former president of the Philippines, on trial for crimes against humanity. These include murders allegedly committed during his campaign against the trade in illegal drugs, which killed at least 6,000 suspects. (He denies the charges.)

The ICC is letting Mr Duterte remain in the jail cell he has occupied for 11 months rather than insisting that he attend the hearings. However, the court pointedly ignored the 80-year-old ex-president's personal submission that he is too "old, tired and frail" to attend. If the judges put him on trial, expect his lawyers to make that argument more loudly.

Photograph: DPA

Germany’s fragile economic recovery

On Monday Germany’s Ifo Institute for Economic Research will release its business-sentiment index. In January it was unchanged from the previous month because business leaders were uncertain about the strength of an expected economic recovery. They are probably not much more confident now.

The German economy is showing signs of recovery from recession but it is fragile. Last month the government of Friedrich Merz downgraded its forecast for growth this year from 1.3% to 1%. The government’s large increase in spending on rearmament and infrastructure is starting to create growth in construction and manufacturing, but it remains unclear whether it will lead to a sustainable recovery. Meanwhile, high energy and labour costs and geopolitical risks, particularly the escalation of trade tensions with America, are hurting the export-oriented German economy. And makers of cars and machinery, among the champions of German industry, are still figuring out how to compete against upstart Chinese rivals.

Illustration: Sandra Navarro

Daily quiz

We will serve you a new question each weekday. On Friday your challenge is to give us all five answers and tell us the theme. Email your responses (and your home city and country) by 1700 GMT on Friday to . We'll pick three winners at random and crown them on Saturday.

Monday: Which American statesman who was secretary of state under Richard Nixon died in 2023 at the age of 100?

The cost of liberty is less than the price of repression.

W. E. B. Du Bois